# Arc quick reference



## TOOLS (LEFT BAR)

| | |
|---|---|
| V | Select |
| E | Measuring tape |
| W | Wall |
| R | Room (four walls at once) |
| D / N | Door / Window |
| S | Stairs |
| A | Floors & baseboards |
| O | Outdoor: patios, decks, fences, lot lines |
| U | MEP: ducts, pipes & wires |
| F / G | Roof / Porch |
| K | Paint & materials |
| Y | Decorate (colour palettes) |
| B | Blocks: furniture, cabinets, fixtures |
| M / C | Move / Duplicate |
| Q / X | Rotate / Mirror |
| Del | Delete what's selected |

The letter in each tool's corner is its key. The status bar at the bottom always says what to click next.

## EVERYDAY KEYS

| | |
|---|---|
| Esc | Finish or cancel; back to Select |
| Enter | Use the size you typed |
| Ctrl+Z / Y | Undo / Redo |
| Ctrl+S / P | Save / print this floor plan |
| Ctrl+L | Lock the selection (click it to unlock) |
| Ctrl+C V X | Copy, paste (into any plan), cut |
| Ctrl+K | Search for any command |
| Ctrl+, | Preferences |
| Z | Zoom to fit the plan |
| F | While drawing: flip the wall's side, or a door's hinge |
| D | Measuring: keep the last leg as a dimension |
| Shift+click | Add to (or take from) the selection |

## TYPING SIZES

While a tool waits for a click, just type, then press Enter. It shows in the **Size** box.

| | |
|---|---|
| 14'6" 14'-6" | Feet and inches |
| 14' 6 1/2" | With fractions |
| 174" 14.5' | All inches, or decimal feet |
| 3600mm 3.6m | Metric works in any plan |
| 12'<45 | Wall or line: length at an angle |
| 32' x 24' | Room: width by depth |
| 2'6" | Door or window: distance from the blue end |

## DRAWING WALLS AND ROOMS

- **Wall**: click the start, then each corner. Right-click, double-click or Esc to stop. Click the first corner to close a room.
- Rooms are found by themselves when walls close a space. Select one to name it and set its floor and ceiling.
- Drag a wall to push it; drag a blue grip to move an end.
- **Snap** ▾: angle lock, Snap to walls, Round to, ft-in or mm. Hold Shift to free the angle for a moment.

## DOORS AND WINDOWS

- Hover over a wall to see the distance to each end; click to place.
- The door swings to the side your cursor is on; F flips the hinge.
- **Several at once** (panel): set **How many**, then Equal sections, Equal gaps, Centred on the wall, From the end, or From where I click. One click places them all.

## SELECTING

- Click to select; the panel on the right shows its settings.
- Drag a box **left → right**: things fully inside. **Right → left**: anything it touches.
- Nothing selected: the panel shows the **Project** and the **Design check**.

## MOVING AROUND THE PLAN

| | |
|---|---|
| Wheel | Zoom toward the cursor |
| Right / middle drag | Pan |
| Space + drag | Pan |
| Z | Zoom to fit (or the corners icon on the top bar) |

## IPAD: FINGERS AND PENCIL

| | |
|---|---|
| Pencil | Draws; hover to see the preview; double-tap for Select |
| One finger | Pans and taps to select once a Pencil is used (draws before that, or with Fingers draw on) |
| Two fingers | Pan and pinch to zoom |
| Two-finger tap | Undo |
| Long press | Right-click (finish a wall) |

## THE 3D VIEW

| | |
|---|---|
| Drag | Orbit (one finger) |
| Right drag | Pan (two fingers) |
| Wheel | Zoom (pinch) |
| Double-click | Centre on that spot |
| Go inside… | Stand in a room: drag to look, wheel to step |
| Walk | W A S D or arrows, drag to look, F flies, Esc stops |
| Compass | Click a letter for a square view |

View list: Full model, Framing, MEP, Roof off, X-ray, Wireframe. **Sun** for real shadows, **Render** for a photo-like picture.

## TOP BAR MENUS

| | |
|---|---|
| **File** | New, templates, open, samples, save, imports (DXF, DWG, PDF, scans) |
| **Export** | Render, PDF, DXF, DWG, IFC, 3D models, takeoff |
| **Design** | Style packs, kitchens, closets, room layouts, furnish, specs, code summary, schedules |
| **View** | What 3D shows; plan overlays |
| **Draw** | Lines, text, hatch, dimensions, sections, 3D shapes, terraces |
| **Modify** | Offset, trim, fillet, array, align, copy & paste |
| **Show** | Dimensions, grid, floor patterns, wall fill |
| **Sheets** | Drawing sheets with a title block, to PDF |

## AUTOCAD KEYS (BUTTON, BOTTOM RIGHT)

| | |
|---|---|
| L PL REC C A | Line, polyline, rectangle, circle, arc |
| H DIM T | Hatch, dimension, text |
| M CO RO MI SC | Move, duplicate, rotate, mirror, scale |
| O TR EX F AR | Offset, trim, extend, fillet, array |
| W I BOX | Wall, insert a block, 3D shape |
| E U Z | Erase, undo, zoom to fit |
| PLOT TAKEOFF | PDF, takeoff & costs |

Type the letters, then Enter or Space. Space alone repeats the last command.

## 3D PRINTING AND PHOTOS

| | |
|---|---|
| **3D Print** | Top bar: the workspace, in seven sections |
| 1 · 2 | Printer and bed · model ground, plates, colour change |
| 3 · 4 | Surfaces (cobbles, bricks) · printed inserts and snow |
| 5 · 6 · 7 | Parts list and $ · check and save · watch-outs |
| Fit test | Section 1: tab, pegs and colour step to print first |
| **Photo eraser** | Export ▾ → Touch up a photo: brush, then Erase |

## GETTING HELP

- Ctrl+K: type what you want to do ( stairs , pdf , sofa ).
- **?** on a panel heading opens the guide at that topic.
- **Guide** ▾ on the top bar: every video lesson, the hands-on lessons and the user guide.
- **Guide** ▾ → **Hands-on lessons…**: build a small house step by step.
- **Video lessons**: short videos, start to finish.
- **File** ▾ → **Samples…**: finished plans to explore.

Design check warnings: **Show** finds it, **Ignore** sets it aside, **Note** keeps your reason with the plan.

Code checks are a guide for early design; a licensed professional and the building official have the final say.